

The Noble Hundred and Eight Names of Maitreya, together with the Dhāraṇī-Mantra

Āryamaitreyāṣṭaśatanāmādhāraṇīmantrasahita · Toh 875 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་བཅུ་པ་འཁོན་བརྒྱ་མཉམ་པ་གཟུངས་སྒྲུས་དང་བཅས་པ།

The Noble Hundred and Eight Names of Maitreya, together with the Dhāraṇī-Mantra (in Tibetan, Phakpa Jampé Tsen Gya Tsa Gyépa Zungngak Dang Chépa) is a short devotional and ritual text centered on the bodhisattva Maitreya, the future buddha. It is Toh 875 in the Kangyur, and it belongs to the tantra class of texts, which is evident from its focus on mantra and dhāraṇī. The text opens with homage to Maitreya, who then speaks his own heart mantra, which the assembled Tathāgatas praise as a dhāraṇī of immense qualities that is extremely rare to hear and free from all obscurations. From there it moves into the litany of Maitreya's names that gives the work its title, a form of praise that doubles as a vehicle for the protective and purifying benefits attributed to reciting them. A Sanskrit title is not given in the details available here, so it is best described simply as a Maitreya name-litany with accompanying dhāraṇī.

The Noble Hundred and Eight Names of Maitreya, together with the Dhāraṇī-Mantra.

Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being Maitreya.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Maitreya, spoke his own heart mantra:

namas traiyadhvikānām sarvatathāgatānām, tadyathā, oṃ sara sara, suru suru, dhara dhara, mahādhara, cara cara, mahācara, bhara bhara, mahābhara, kampa kampa, mahākampa hūṃ, mahāsphāraṇa, dharmāgrasāgara svāhā.

Then all the Tathāgatas declared: "Ah! This great dhāraṇī has immense qualities and pervades without limit. Even in many tens of millions of eons it is extremely hard to hear. It reveals the appearance of all buddhas. Countless Tathāgatas, as many as there are world systems, have honored and revered it. It brings freedom from all obscurations, sufferings, disturbances, bad dreams, and ill omens. It completely liberates the infinite and boundless realm of sentient beings. It is exceedingly rare."

Then the assembly of the vajra maṇḍala, together with gods and asuras, adorned with jeweled crowns, their garlands of ornaments swaying, joined their palms at the crowns of their heads and extolled the supreme bodhisattva, noble Maitreya, with a hundred and eight names:

Great hero who has found the means,
Regent, lord of humankind,
Lord of the world, shining clear,
Greatly flourishing, fully expanded,
Great and mighty, endowed with strength, exalted,
Likewise vast and free of dust,
Radiant like the summit of Mahendra,
Lord of the earth, the subduer,
Great king of a hundred weapons,
Great weapon, the vajra weapon,
Adorned with a hundred lights of qualities,
Wearing jeweled earrings as ornaments,
Body majestic throughout the three realms of existence,
Whose field of activity is like the ocean,
Rising as a maṇḍala from the summits
Of Meru, the moon-rising mountain, and Kailāsa,
Enjoyer of the great maṇḍala,
Supremely joyful, thus is he,
God of the great and wholly joyful Tuṣita,
Exalted one, supreme among all gods,
Who makes the lineage of the buddhas flourish,
Endowed with the ornament of the buddhas' maṇḍala,
Enjoying the enjoyments of the buddhas,
Teacher of the Buddha's doctrine,
Vast like Kailāsa and the moon-rising mountain,
Lord of the earth who brings happiness,
Crowned with a thousand-petaled lotus,
Vajra lotus, well born,
Enjoying the enjoyment of the Dharma,
Equal to the earth, hard to overcome,
The illuminator, the source,
Sun of wisdom for the three realms of existence,
Great chief, greatly renowned,
Great lion of great strength,
Of great attire and majestic countenance,
Taming wicked beings and suffering,
Bearing as an ornament a diadem of jewels,

Of vajra, coral, and beryl,
Upon a floor spread with coral and gold
The great body moves with striding steps,
Face aglow with the splendor of many suns,
With braided locks, crown, and diadem,
Vidyādharas bow at his feet,
Honored by those worthy of veneration,
With the rays of a hundred swaying jewels
The expanse of his chest is made pure,
Crowned and glittering with light,
Radiant as a billion suns,
Spread with the finest jewels of every kind,
A stainless maṇḍala radiating far,
With a gaze like a great blaze
Stirred entirely by the wind,
Struck by many rays of light,
Fully revealing the means of benefit,
His face bright with the light
Of his majestic smile, yak-tail whisks waving,
Armlets set with interwoven rays,
Gleaming, beautiful as painted colors,
Like Meru mountains clashing in turmoil
He proclaims the great sound "Ha ha!",
Great vajra, delighting in play,
Bringer of great joy, giver of bliss,
Clad in the armor of the maṇḍala of love,
Victorious over all the mighty,
Arisen from the power of compassion,
Great weapon fiercely blazing,
Maitreya, whose every thought is love,
Of a maṇḍala majestic in every way,
Ajita, unconquerable, pure,
Great in a buddha's incomparable guise,
Heart of love, great heart,
Born from the lotus of love,
Great Vajradhara, bearer of the vajra,
Of the maṇḍala of the vajra teaching,

Bowed to by the vidyādhara,
Likewise attended and extolled,
Great siddha, accomplished in the vidyā-mantra,
Who beautifies the vajra maṇḍala,
Accomplisher who accomplishes all,
Great trunk of the buddhas' lineage,
Ascertainer of the great secret mantra,
Arranger and compiler of the sūtras,
Certain, with the light of the lamp of certainty
He dispels all stains,
Blazing with crimson radiance,
Great white maṇḍala,
In accord with scripture, close to the dharmadhātu
And utterly certain,
Supreme lord of svāhā svāhā,
Rays of good fortune, bringer of good fortune,
Bearer of great strength, auspicious,
Like the sun, impartial to all,
Giver of strength, possessing the Victor's enjoyments,
Whose sphere is stainless like the sky,
Hero who conquers with the vajra,
Great vajra, perfect accomplisher,
Accomplisher beyond dispute,
Possessor of the maṇḍala, revealer of the vajra,
Stirred by the force of a mighty wind,
With the sound of quaking and roaring thunder,
Lotus, the sphere of the buddhas,
Born from the lake of suchness,
Great in clairvoyance, having attained clairvoyance,
All-pervading lord, equal to all buddhas.

Then, when Maitreya, lord of the earth,
Of the maṇḍala of love, had been praised,
The omniscient Sun of Sages, free from all harm,
Declared these words:

"Ah! These supreme hundred and eight names,
Radiant with the qualities of the names,

Accomplishing happiness and excellence,
Are an unsurpassed great means.
These hundred and eight names
Bring forth happiness for all the world.
By merely reciting them
All evil deeds are purified.
Whatever person, with these sacred hundred and eight names,
Praises Maitreya, victorious over evil,
The very abode of praise,
For that person all the gods and others,
And the mighty Vajrapāṇis,
Constantly strive
To remove all suffering forever.
Whoever swiftly recites
The supreme hundred and eight names
Will attain even the ground of buddhahood;
Of this there is no doubt.
Whoever, rising from bed in the morning,
Offers praise with a mind of love,
For that one Maitreya, who has realized love,
Will bring about good fortune.
Therefore, make a point of reciting purely
The hundred and eight names
That dispel all stains, destroy evil,
Give rise to all good qualities,
And likewise dispel the sufferings of the world."
Here ends The Noble Hundred and Eight Names of Maitreya, together with the
Dhāraṇī-Mantra.

Translator's Notes

- The mountain called "zla 'byin" ("moon-producing"), paired with Meru and Kailāsa, is rendered literally as "the moon-rising mountain," since I could not securely identify the Sanskrit name. "dbang chen rtse" is taken as the summit of Mount Mahendra. The mantra is given as transliterated in the Tibetan. The Tibetan "mahā gampa" is read as the standard "mahākampa." "ma pham" is Maitreya's standard epithet Ajita, so it is given in its Sanskrit form. "Sun of Sages" (thub pa nyi ma) is kept as an epithet of the Buddha.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.